

VINITHA MAHADEVAN

Lead Release Train Engineer | SAFe RTE | Agile Transformation Leader
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Lead Release Train Engineer with 20+ years of experience in Agile program management, SAFe implementation, and large-scale technology delivery. Expert in orchestrating continuous planning across the full value stream — from intake and discovery through flow management, value delivery, and Inspect & Adapt embedded within these processes. Proven track record of leading multiple Agile Release Trains (ARTs) across cross-functional teams to drive end-to-end value delivery. Adept at leading distributed teams (onshore/offshore) and partnering with executive leadership. Driving AI transformation by facilitating AI training using Claude and Claude Code to accelerate delivery and innovation. Deep domain experience across automotive, healthcare, insurance, banking, retail, manufacturing, and logistics sectors.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Agile & SAFe: PI Planning, ART Execution, Scrum of Scrums, Kanban, Lean-Agile, Inspect & Adapt, Continuous Planning (Intake, Discovery, Flow, Value Delivery) | **Program Management:** Release Planning, Dependency & Risk Mgmt, Capacity Planning, Demand Management | **AI Transformation:** AI Training Facilitation (Claude, Claude Code), AI Adoption | **Leadership:** Coaching & Mentoring, Servant Leadership, Facilitation, Stakeholder Management, Process Re-engineering | **Tools:** Jira, Confluence, Rally, MS Project, SAFe, Scrum, Kanban

EXPERIENCE

Lead Release Train Engineer | *Cox Automotive Inc.* Apr 2022 – Present
Roswell, GA

- Lead and coach multiple Agile Release Trains (ARTs) comprising 7+ cross-functional teams (50+ engineers), driving end-to-end delivery for the automotive retail ecosystem
- Orchestrate continuous planning across the full value stream — intake, discovery, flow management, value delivery, and Inspect & Adapt embedded within all processes
- Drive AI transformation by facilitating AI training using Claude and Claude Code, enabling teams to accelerate development and innovation
- Facilitate quarterly PI Planning events with 80+ participants, aligning Product, Engineering, Architecture, and Business stakeholders on program objectives and commitments
- Drive continuous improvement through Inspect & Adapt workshops using flow metrics to identify bottlenecks and implement process improvements
- Manage cross-team dependencies, risks, and impediments; escalate strategically to executive sponsors
- Coach Scrum Masters, Product Owners, and teams on SAFe practices and Lean-Agile principles; establish ART-level KPIs and present data-driven insights to leadership

Senior Release Train Engineer | *MerchantE*

Sep 2021 – Mar 2022

Alpharetta, GA

- Served as RTE for payment technology solutions, facilitating ART ceremonies and cross-team coordination; managed program-level backlog and release planning for merchant payment processing platforms

Program Manager | *Anthem, Inc.*

Jan 2018 – Aug 2021

Greater Atlanta Area

- Served as Release Train Engineer for large group Underwriting project in health insurance; managed program execution, stakeholder reporting, and cross-team dependencies for enterprise healthcare initiatives
- Drove Agile adoption and maturity, improving delivery predictability and quality

Program Executive | *Cognizant (Anthem Inc.)*

Mar 2016 – Dec 2017

- Led program management for Anthem account, managing delivery across multiple workstreams; coordinated with client leadership to align program milestones with business objectives

Portfolio Project Manager | *Cognizant (Sallie Mae)*

Jan 2015 – Feb 2016

- Managed portfolio demand management and release delivery for student lending programs; mentored project managers and established standardized processes

Senior Manager | *Cognizant (Express Scripts)*

Feb 2013 – Dec 2014

Orlando, FL

- Managed specialty pharmacy projects for Integration and Intake portfolio; led demand planning, forecasting, budgeting; mentored project managers; drove process re-engineering for Intake

Senior Manager | *Cognizant (Wellpoint)*

Oct 2010 – Jan 2013

Richmond, VA

- Managed programs across multiple teams/vendors with 200+ resources; led business solutions development, process re-engineering, budgeting, and implementation
- Coached senior staff; developed project roadmaps, change management, risk assessment, and stakeholder reporting

Project Manager – Senior Programmer Analyst |

Oct 2007 – Oct 2010

Cognizant (BCBSM, NASCO, Wellpoint)

Senior Programmer Analyst (Jul 2003 – Oct 2007): WI, MI

- Managed mid-size projects in the healthcare payer space. Developed solutions on LAWSON HR/Financials at Schneider National, WI; led technical teams (onsite/offshore) for claims migration at BCBSM, MI

Technical Software Consultant | *Deutsche Bank*

Jun 2000 – Jul 2003

- Developed and enhanced Corporate Banking and Investment Banking applications; worked across global teams (U.K., USA, Singapore, Malaysia, India)

CERTIFICATIONS

SAFe 4 Release Train Engineer (RTE) — Scaled Agile, Inc. (Oct 2020) | SAFe 4 Advanced Scrum Master (SASM) — Scaled Agile, Inc. (Jun 2020) | SAFe 4 Product Owner/Product Manager (POPM) — Scaled Agile, Inc. (Jul 2020)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering — University of Madras, Chennai